ILLIA SHPAK

Engineering Leader | Platform, Reliability & Security

London / Dubai | Working globally
linkedin.com/in/illiash | github.com/illia-sh | illia-sh.github.io/aboutme

Hands-on engineering leader with 15+ years across fintech, banking, fashion, and travel. Builds distributed teams and connects platform engineering, security, developer experience, and cloud strategy with business growth. Open to CTO, VP Engineering, and Head of Platform opportunities.

SELECTED IMPACT

Lean: grew DevOps & SRE from 2 to 8 across four regions; reduced infrastructure spend by 50%; supported the business from seed through Series B.
DREST: saved $500K through re-architecture; moved deployments from weekly to multiple times per hour.

EXPERIENCE

Head of DevOps & SRE

Lean Technologies | London / Dubai / Riyadh | 2022-Present

- Led multi-cloud infrastructure, FinOps governance, developer self-service, and infrastructure controls supporting regulated operations and SAMA licensing.
- Designed business continuity and disaster recovery across OCI, GCP, and AWS. Supported a platform serving 250+ clients and processing $2B+ in transactions.

VP Cloud / Systems Architect

JPMorgan Chase | London | 2021-2022

- Contributed to a global digital call center platform: real-time data integration, WebRTC quality metrics, and intelligent call routing.
- The solution was presented at AWS re:Invent 2022 as reference architecture.

Head of DevOps & Security

DREST | London | 2019-2021

- Reported to the CEO/CTO. Identified infrastructure inefficiencies and led a full-stack migration, saving $500K and increasing deployment frequency.

Lead DevOps Engineer

Burberry, via EPAM | London | 2017-2019

- Reduced infrastructure costs by 40%; managed GitLab for 150+ engineers; completed AWS security remediation in 3 weeks against a 2-month plan.

Senior DevOps / SRE Engineer

Thomas Cook, via EPAM | Minsk / London | 2011-2017

- Led 12 engineers. Migrated EU data centers covering 400+ instances with minimal downtime, and deployed monitoring for 500+ instances.

PRODUCTS & EXPERTISE

DzeTruck: B2B construction logistics marketplace with paying clients; Firebase, React, Flutter.
Menu Scanner: AI-powered dietary analysis; Next.js, Cloud Run, Google Cloud Vision.

Team building, hiring, OKRs, executive collaboration, cloud contract negotiation, AWS, GCP, OCI, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitOps, FinOps, observability, security, and disaster recovery.

CREDENTIALS & CONTINUED LEARNING

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate | GCP Professional Cloud Architect | Chef Certified Developer
Additional training: Google Project Management; Y Combinator Startup School; SRE: Measuring & Managing Reliability; ELK Machine Learning.